

Chapter 63-2

Liang Father poured a cup of tea, the fragrant steam slightly diluting the sadness from moments before.

He also poured a cup for Liang Xinzhou. Liang Xinzhou picked it up, took a sip, then asked gently, "Dad, are you still looking for that missing sister?"

Liang Father nodded, "All these years, it's been a constant worry for your mother and me. Finding her would put our hearts at ease, otherwise..."

He paused and smiled bitterly, "I'd feel guilty even on my deathbed."

Back then, it was he who had brought his newborn daughter to the gathering, and it was his carelessness—being busy playing with friends and leaving his daughter aside.

Mr. Gao, who had also lost his daughter along with him, had already passed away.

His family was broken, his wife and children scattered.

That was truly tragic.

But all these years, whenever he thought of Old Gao, his heart felt blocked with grief.

If it weren't for having two other children at home to somewhat alleviate the inner anguish, he probably wouldn't have fared much better either.

Even so, this guilt had weighed on his heart for many years.

After Liang Father finished speaking, he glanced at Liang Xinzhou, "Are you trying to persuade us to stop looking?"

Liang Xinzhou pursed his lips, set his teacup down heavily on the table, removed his glasses to wipe the fog from them, and said bluntly, "Yes, I don't quite understand why you want to find her."

Liang Father frowned, his voice suddenly stern, "What do you mean by that?"

"To be precise, I don't know why you want to find her. If you were determined to find her, then you shouldn't have brought Liang Shi home in the first place." Liang Xinzhou, having worked in the company for years, had developed an increasingly sharp demeanor. Even facing his father, who had dominated the business world for years, he didn't back down. "You brought Liang Shi home, and we all considered her our sister. But now that Liang Shi has grown up, you tell us you've been looking for our real sister all along. Have you considered that this would be hurtful to everyone?"

Liang Father said coldly, "So we should just stop looking? Let your real sister wander outside? Let her suffer hardship?"

"Then have you considered what Liang Shi should do? When your biological daughter comes back, what should Liang Shi do? How can she still set foot in this house? How can she still call you Dad?" Liang Xinzhou said calmly, "If you bring your biological daughter back, the established way our family has interacted all these years will change. We also don't know how to treat a sudden stranger. Blood ties are great, but all these years of getting along together can't be fake either. Initially, it was because of Liang Shi's arrival that Mom stabilized emotionally. She's also an innocent person who got involved. Are we supposed to cut ties with her now?"

Liang Xinzhou analyzed the current situation as coldly as an AI, "Once someone new enters, the ecological balance of our family will be disrupted."

"If your biological daughter is living well outside, harmonious with her adoptive parents, then your appearance would also create waves in her peaceful life, putting her in a difficult position. If she's not living well, then she would have qualities that clash with this social class and this family. The vision, upbringing, demeanor, and etiquette that money can provide—she wouldn't know any of these, having never experienced them. You bring such a person in, desperately trying to make up for lost time, and then what?"

"Everything in this house would have to give way to her, and everyone would have to help her. Your two daughters-in-law both live here—how much energy would they have to spend getting along with this new sister-in-law who has never seen the world?"

"This is still the best-case scenario." After Liang Xinzhou finished speaking, he closed his eyes, "If she has even more flaws, this family could very well fall apart because of her."

Liang Father slammed the table, "What kind of talk is this? She's your real sister. Just because she's been wandering outside for many years, doesn't she deserve to enter the Liang family door?"

"It's not that." Liang Xinzhou remained rational, "If I had to choose between Liang Shi and someone I've never met, I choose Liang Shi."

"She's from a completely different social class than all of you." Liang Father said, "Some child picked up from who knows where. I raised her, gave her food and clothing, let her see so much of the world, but she still became a scoundrel, an uneducated second-generation rich kid, a wastrel. Because of her, I've nearly lost all face!"

"But she's obedient and well-behaved, she's someone we know well, she's a controllable factor." Liang Xinzhou looked at him, "But can you say that because of her waywardness, you gained nothing?"

Liang Xinzhou asked lightly, "If it weren't for her, our cooperation with Huaguang Group wouldn't have been so easy. Without her, our relationship with the Lin family wouldn't be what it is, and we couldn't have become business partners. She may seem unruly, but has she ever done anything to harm the Liang family?"

Liang Father was immediately rendered speechless.

All these years, Liang Xinzhou had always indulged this sister because he knew she wouldn't do anything particularly outrageous.

She might have a chaotic private life, might like gambling and drinking, like calling friends together, playing with disreputable things.

But she had never done a single thing harmful to the Liang family.

She was like walking a tightrope, always on the dangerous edge.

But whenever she reached the edge of harming the Liang family, she would definitely pull back in time.

Liang Xinzhou looked at his father, "I'll leave my words here: if you find your biological daughter and bring her back, given the extent of your and Mom's guilt, this family will definitely be full of constant quarrels."

Liang Father glanced at him, "You're being too hasty with those words."

"Actually, the reasoning is simple." Liang Xinzhou said, "You understand it even without me saying it. If you insist on doing this, Yuwan and I will move out of the old house when the time comes."

Liang Father frowned, "Are you threatening me?"

Liang Xinzhou shook his head, "You know that Yuwan and I plan to have children. We're currently trying to conceive. I don't want her to be distracted by other matters."

Liang Father suddenly slumped in his chair and asked wearily, "Is this because of Liang Shi? Just because she saved you once?"

"Yes, and no." Liang Xinzhou answered after thinking, "I prefer to get along with people I know inside and out. Last time when Liang Shi saved me, it made me realize that getting along is more important than blood ties."

"Actually, like all of you, I once looked forward to our third sister coming back." Liang Xinzhou said, "But later I felt that Liang Shi is my sister, and this family can't handle having another person join. Regardless of whether that person is good or bad."

"So you want us to abandon our biological daughter?" Liang Father asked heavily.

Liang Xinzhou exhaled heavily, "Perhaps you still remember the trolley problem¹ you once told me about?"

A madman tied five people to the tracks, and a trolley was approaching. The trolley could choose to switch tracks, but on the other track, there was also one person.

So should one choose to stay on the original track and kill five people? Or choose to switch tracks and kill one person?

This was a situation where someone was destined to be sacrificed.

Life cannot be weighed on scales, and the value of five people isn't necessarily greater than one person.

But...

For Liang Xinzhou, his choice was absolute.

"The reason is simple." Liang Xinzhou said, "Whether in company management or family building, I choose to protect the option with more people."

So rather than letting an unstable factor enter the family and expose it to too many unknown risks.

Liang Xinzhou chose to sacrifice that biological sister he'd never met.

Liang Father suddenly fell into silence.

Liang Xinzhou stood up, "Of course, you haven't found your daughter yet. I'm just advising you to give up."

"If someday you do find her," Liang Xinzhou said solemnly, "I hope you'll think about what I said today before making your decision."

Footnotes:

¹ Trolley problem: A famous ethical thought experiment in philosophy about moral decision-making when faced with choosing between harmful outcomes.